

D765

Special Education Curriculum

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A 9-year-old has a full-scale IQ of 66 on an individual test. Adaptive behavior ratings from home and school are in the average range. He has a younger brother and rides the bus 40 minutes each way. What does this pattern suggest?

- A. He has autism.
- B. He has an intellectual disability because his IQ is below 70.
- C. He does not meet criteria for intellectual disability, because adaptive behavior is not significantly limited.
- D. The long bus ride lowered his score.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student has significant adaptive behavior deficits that began in early childhood. What else is required to identify an intellectual disability?

- A. A reading score below grade level.
- B. Onset after age 22.
- C. Nothing; adaptive deficits alone are enough.
- D. Significant limits in intellectual functioning, typically about two standard deviations below the mean.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A kindergartner reads chapter books, lines up toy cars by color, gets very upset when the schedule changes, and rarely starts conversations with peers. His parents are both engineers and he has a pet turtle. Which description best fits these characteristics?

- A. Intellectual disability, because of the upset over schedule changes.
- B. Behavior learned from his engineer parents.
- C. Characteristics consistent with autism, including advanced skills in some areas.
- D. Typical development, because he reads chapter books.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A student with a learning disability answers single-digit multiplication facts correctly 50% of the time. The class uses colorful fact cards, and he sits near the teacher. Which instruction best fits his stage?

- A. One-minute timed fact drills.
- B. More colorful fact cards.
- C. Applying facts in new word problems.
- D. Modeling, guided practice, and immediate corrective feedback to build accuracy.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student reads a list of sight words with 100% accuracy but at only 15 words per minute. What instruction fits next?

- A. Stop practice, because accuracy is perfect.
- B. Brief, repeated, timed practice with goal setting to build speed.
- C. Move to new words immediately.
- D. Reteach each word with modeling.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A seventh grader with a learning disability cannot write a paragraph alone but writes a solid one when given a sentence-starter frame. The class has a new set of laptops and meets on the second floor. What should the teacher plan?

- A. Use the frame now and gradually reduce it until he writes paragraphs without it.
- B. Give him the frame permanently.
- C. Remove the frame now so he learns faster.
- D. Have him type on the new laptops instead.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

Midway through a fractions lesson, a special education teacher gives a three-question exit slip and uses the results to regroup students for tomorrow. The slips are printed on green paper and the lesson ran long. What type of assessment is this?

- A. Summative
- B. Formative
- C. Norm-referenced
- D. Diagnostic, because it is short

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher gives a unit test, records grades, and moves to the next unit without using the results to change instruction. What type of assessment is this?

- A. Progress monitoring
- B. Formative
- C. Screening
- D. Summative

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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9.

A fifth grader has a medical diagnosis of ADHD, and his attention problems limit his progress so that he needs specially designed instruction. His mother is a nurse and he plays chess. Under which IDEA category would he most likely qualify?

- A. Other Health Impairment
- B. Emotional disturbance
- C. ADHD, a separate IDEA category
- D. Section 504 only, because his mother is a nurse

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student has a diagnosis of dyslexia and needs specially designed reading instruction. Which IDEA category most likely applies?

- A.** Speech or Language Impairment
- B.** Other Health Impairment
- C.** Specific Learning Disability
- D.** Dyslexia, a separate IDEA category

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A student with a communication disorder uses her device to tell her teacher that an adult at home hurts her. The teacher has worked at the school six years and has a planning period next. What must the teacher do?

- A.** Report to child protective services or law enforcement as state law requires, without investigating first.
- B.** Wait until the planning period ends.
- C.** Ask more questions to gather proof before reporting.
- D.** Tell only the principal and let her decide.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A sixth grader scores in the very superior range on verbal reasoning, leads class debates, and writes only a few illegible sentences on any assignment. He takes piano lessons and his school has a new principal. What should the team consider?

- A.** Replace writing with piano as an outlet.
- B.** He may be twice-exceptional; evaluate the writing weakness while also serving his advanced abilities.
- C.** He is not trying hard enough.
- D.** He cannot have a disability because he is gifted.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A 9-year-old has a full-scale IQ of 66 on an individual test. Adaptive behavior ratings from home and school are in the average range. ~~He has a younger brother and rides the bus 40 minutes each way.~~ What does this pattern suggest?

Target word: ID criteria **Decides:** Adaptive behavior is average, so both criteria are not met.

A	Adjacent category	Nothing described fits autism criteria.
B	Dropped element	Drops the adaptive behavior requirement.
C	Correct	ID requires deficits in both intellectual functioning and adaptive behavior.
D	Camouflage	The ride does not explain the pattern.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

A student has significant adaptive behavior deficits that began in early childhood. What else is required to identify an intellectual disability?

Target word: the missing criterion **Decides:** Significant limits in intellectual functioning.

A	Adjacent category	Low achievement is not the intellectual criterion.
B	Inverted operation	Onset must be during the developmental period.
C	Dropped element	Both criteria must be met.
D	Correct	Both intellectual and adaptive limits are required.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A kindergartner reads chapter books, lines up toy cars by color, gets very upset when the schedule changes, and rarely starts conversations with peers. ~~His parents are both engineers and he has a pet turtle.~~ Which description best fits these characteristics?

Target word: identify autism features **Decides:** Social communication differences plus restricted, repetitive behaviors.

A	Adjacent category	His reading shows strong ability; autism does not mean ID.
B	Camouflage	Parents' jobs do not explain the pattern.
C	Correct	Social and repetitive-behavior features with uneven skills fit autism.
D	Dropped element	Ignores the social and repetitive features.

4. Answer D Concept 3

A student with a learning disability answers single-digit multiplication facts correctly 50% of the time. ~~The class uses colorful fact cards, and he sits near the teacher.~~ Which instruction best fits his stage?

Target word: match instruction to acquisition stage **Decides:** 50% accuracy = acquisition stage.

A	Adjacent category	Timed drills fit the fluency stage, after accuracy.
B	Camouflage	Materials do not decide the instructional stage.
C	Inverted operation	Generalization comes after accuracy and fluency.
D	Correct	Acquisition-stage learners need accuracy-building instruction.

5. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

A student reads a list of sight words with 100% accuracy but at only 15 words per minute. What instruction fits next?

Target word: fluency stage **Decides:** Accurate but slow = fluency stage.

A	Absolute language	Accuracy without speed is not mastery.
B	Correct	Fluency-stage learners need practice to build rate.
C	Dropped element	Skips the fluency stage.
D	Inverted operation	Accuracy is already mastered.

6. Answer A Concept 4

A seventh grader with a learning disability cannot write a paragraph alone but writes a solid one when given a sentence-starter frame. ~~The class has a new set of laptops and meets on the second floor.~~ What should the teacher plan?

Target word: scaffolding use **Decides:** The task is in his ZPD; supports should fade.

A	Correct	Scaffolds are temporary and fade as skill grows.
B	Absolute language	Permanent scaffolds block independence.
C	Inverted operation	He cannot yet do the task alone.
D	Camouflage	The device does not address the need for fading support.

7. Answer B Concept 5

Midway through a fractions lesson, a special education teacher gives a three-question exit slip and uses the results to regroup students for tomorrow. ~~The slips are printed on green paper and the lesson ran long.~~ What type of assessment is this?

Target word: classify assessment **Decides:** Given during learning and used to adjust instruction.

A	Inverted operation	Summative judges learning at the end.
B	Correct	It checks learning in progress and changes instruction.
C	Confusion set	No comparison to a national norm group.
D	Camouflage	Length and format do not define the type.

8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

A teacher gives a unit test, records grades, and moves to the next unit without using the results to change instruction. What type of assessment is this?

Target word: classify by use **Decides:** End-of-unit judgment with no instructional change.

A	Confusion set	Progress monitoring is frequent and tracks growth over time.
B	Inverted operation	Results are not used to adjust instruction.
C	Adjacent category	Screening flags risk across a population.
D	Correct	It evaluates learning at the end of a unit.

9. Answer A Concept 6

A fifth grader has a medical diagnosis of ADHD, and his attention problems limit his progress so that he needs specially designed instruction. ~~His mother is a nurse and he plays chess.~~ Under which IDEA category would he most likely qualify?

Target word: IDEA category for ADHD **Decides:** ADHD usually qualifies under Other Health Impairment.

A	Correct	IDEA lists ADHD as an example under OHI.
B	Adjacent category	Nothing suggests emotional disturbance criteria.
C	Confusion set	ADHD is not one of the 13 categories.
D	Camouflage	A parent's job does not decide eligibility.

10. Answer C Concept 6 • transfer

A student has a diagnosis of dyslexia and needs specially designed reading instruction. Which IDEA category most likely applies?

Target word: IDEA category for dyslexia **Decides:** Dyslexia is named under Specific Learning Disability.

A	Adjacent category	A related area, but dyslexia is listed under SLD.
B	Inverted operation	OHI covers limited strength, vitality, or alertness, such as ADHD.
C	Correct	IDEA's SLD definition includes dyslexia.
D	Confusion set	Not one of the 13 categories.

11. Answer A Concept 7

A student with a communication disorder uses her device to tell her teacher that an adult at home hurts her. ~~The teacher has worked at the school six years and has a planning period next.~~ What must the teacher do?

Target word: mandated reporter duty **Decides:** Reasonable suspicion triggers a direct report.

A	Correct	Mandated reporters report suspicion directly and promptly.
B	Camouflage	The schedule does not change the duty to report promptly.
C	Dropped element	Teachers report suspicion; investigation is for authorities.
D	Adjacent category	Telling a supervisor does not replace the personal duty to report.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A sixth grader scores in the very superior range on verbal reasoning, leads class debates, and writes only a few illegible sentences on any assignment. ~~He takes piano lessons and his school has a new principal.~~ What should the team consider?

Target word: twice-exceptional profile **Decides:** High ability plus a specific weakness in writing.

A	Camouflage	The piano detail is irrelevant.
B	Correct	Gifted students can have disabilities that their strengths mask.
C	Adjacent category	Assumes motivation without data.
D	Absolute language	Giftedness and disability can co-occur.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Intellectual disability criteria	Intellectual disability requires significant limits in both intellectual functioning (typically about 2 SD below the mean) and adaptive behavior, beginning in the developmental period.	Diagnosing from a low IQ score alone.	An IQ score reported without adaptive behavior data, or the reverse.
2	Core features of autism	Autism involves persistent differences in social communication and interaction plus restricted, repetitive behaviors or interests, including sensory differences; intellectual ability varies widely.	Assuming autism means intellectual disability or that all autistic students avoid people.	A description of social communication differences and routines or sensory responses.
3	Instructional hierarchy	Learners move from acquisition (accuracy) to fluency (speed) to generalization and adaptation; instruction should match the stage, e.g., modeling and feedback for acquisition, timed practice for fluency.	Using timed drills for a student who is still inaccurate.	Accuracy and speed data for the same skill.
4	Scaffolding in the zone of proximal development	Give temporary support for tasks a student can do with help but not alone, and remove it as competence grows.	Keeping supports forever or giving tasks the student can already do alone.	A task the student fails alone but completes with prompts.
5	Formative vs. summative assessment	Formative assessment happens during learning to adjust teaching; summative assessment judges learning at the end of a unit or period.	Labeling any quiz as formative regardless of how results are used.	When the check happens and whether results change the next lesson.
6	IDEA disability categories	IDEA has 13 categories; ADHD usually falls under Other Health Impairment, and dyslexia under Specific Learning Disability.	Thinking ADHD or dyslexia are separate IDEA categories.	A diagnosis that is not one of the 13 category names.
7	Mandated reporting	Teachers who have reasonable suspicion of abuse or neglect must report directly to child protective services or law enforcement as state law requires, without first investigating or waiting for proof.	Only telling the principal, or waiting to gather evidence.	A student's disclosure or unexplained injuries.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Twice-exceptional learners	Students can be gifted and have a disability at the same time; strengths can mask the disability and the disability can mask the gift, so both need support.	Assuming a student with high ability cannot have a disability.	High reasoning ability alongside a specific weakness.

Course scope (public description): Special Education Curriculum is designed for candidates who plan to teach in a special education program at any grade level from kindergarten through grade 12. This course reviews the basic principles of special education and their application in realistic situations. Its focus is on five major content areas: Development and Characteristics of Learners, Planning and the Learning Environment, Instruction, Assessment, and Foundations and Professional Responsibilities which align to CEC Standards.